

August 12, 2026

Humana
Provider Correspondence
P.O. Box 14601
Lexington, KY 40512

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Louis Wisoky (MRN MUSC6784417), Claim MUSC-20250831-4577-1

Patient	Louis Wisoky (DOB 1938-04-09)
MRN	MUSC6784417
Member ID / Group	HUM416532893 / GRP-31881
Claim number	MUSC-20250831-4577-1
Date of service	2025-08-31
Procedure billed	CPT 99214 — Office/outpatient visit, established patient, moderate complexity
Primary diagnosis	J06.9 — Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified
Denied amount	\$341.24
Denial code	CARC 96 / RARC N130 — Non-covered charge(s).
Appeal deadline	2025-12-04

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health is submitting this formal first-level appeal on behalf of patient Louis Wisoky (MRN: MUSC6784417, Member ID: HUM416532893) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-20250831-4577-1 for services rendered on August 31, 2025, by Robert K. Lindqvist, MD (NPI 1314059687) at MUSC Health University Medical Center. Humana denied the claim in full — billed charges of \$341.24 — under CARC 96 ("Non-covered charge(s)") and RARC N130 ("Consult plan benefit documents/guidelines for information about restrictions for this service"), with the payer remark stating: "Service is excluded under the member's plan benefit document." This appeal is submitted within the applicable reconsideration timeframe and respectfully requests that Humana reverse the denial and process the claim for payment.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

Mr. Wisoky is an 88-year-old male with a complex, longstanding medical history that includes chronic obstructive bronchitis, chronic congestive heart failure, a history of cardiac arrest, gout, and osteoporosis, among other active conditions. He carries an active prescription for a fluticasone/salmeterol combination dry powder inhaler, furosemide injection, metoprolol succinate, and alendronic acid, reflecting the ongoing, multi-system nature of his care. The August 31, 2025 encounter was billed as CPT 99214, an established outpatient office visit of moderate complexity, with a primary diagnosis of J06.9 (acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified) and a secondary diagnosis of R69. Given Mr. Wisoky's underlying pulmonary and cardiac conditions — including a documented FEV1/FVC ratio and prior pulmonary rehabilitation — evaluation and management of an acute upper respiratory infection in this patient carries meaningful clinical complexity and risk, appropriately supporting the level of service billed.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

The denial characterizes CPT 99214 as a service excluded under the member's plan benefit document. MUSC Health respectfully disputes this characterization. CPT 99214 represents a standard evaluation and management service for an established outpatient patient — one of the most fundamental and universally covered service categories under Medicare Advantage plans. Medicare Advantage plans are required by federal regulation to cover, at minimum, all services covered under traditional Medicare, and office and outpatient evaluation and management visits are a core Medicare benefit. A blanket exclusion of an established-patient office visit would be inconsistent with these federal coverage requirements.

Humana's remittance does not identify any specific benefit exclusion language, a plan-defined frequency limitation, or a clinical basis for non-coverage. RARC N130 directs the provider to consult plan benefit documents, yet no specific exclusion has been cited that would apply to a routine evaluation and management visit for an acute illness in an established patient. In the absence of a clearly articulated and plan-document-supported exclusion, denial under CARC 96 is not substantiated. MUSC Health requests that Humana identify, in its reconsideration response, the precise benefit exclusion language upon which this denial rests. If no such exclusion exists or applies to this service, the claim must be adjudicated and paid at the contracted rate.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health respectfully requests that Humana conduct a thorough reconsideration of Claim MUSC-20250831-4577-1, reverse the denial issued under CARC 96 and RARC N130, and reprocess the claim for payment in accordance with the contracted rate and applicable Medicare Advantage coverage requirements. Should Humana uphold the denial, we request a written explanation identifying the specific plan benefit exclusion language applicable to CPT 99214 for this member, as well as information regarding the next level of appeal available under the Humana Advantage plan and applicable Medicare Advantage grievance and appeals procedures.

Respectfully submitted,

Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC

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Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record